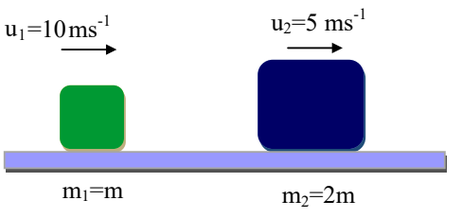
The equation (4.61) implies that the first body which is heavier continues to move with the same initial velocity. The equation (4.62) suggests that the second body which is lighter will move with twice the initial velocity of the first body. It means that the lighter body is thrown away from the point of collision.

EXAMPLE 4.20

A lighter particle moving with a speed of 10 m s^{-1} collides with an object of double its mass moving in the same direction with half its speed. Assume that the collision is a one dimensional elastic collision. What will be the speed of both particles after the collision?

Solution



Let the mass of the first body be *m* which moves with an initial velocity, $u_1 = 10$ m s^{-1}. Therefore, the mass of second body is *2m* and its initial velocity is $u_2 = \frac{1}{2} u_1 = \frac{1}{2}(10 \text{ m s}^{-1})$,

Then, the final velocities of the bodies can be calculated from the equation (4.53) and equation (4.54)

$$v_1 = \left(\frac{m_1 - m_2}{m_1 + m_2}\right) u_1 + \left(\frac{2m_2}{m_1 + m_2}\right) u_2$$

$$v_1 = \left(\frac{m - 2m}{m + 2m}\right) 10 + \left(\frac{2 \times 2m}{m + 2m}\right) 5$$

$$v_1 = -\left(\frac{1}{3}\right) 10 + \left(\frac{4}{3}\right) 5 = \frac{-10 + 20}{3} = \frac{10}{3}$$

$$v_1 = 3.33 \text{ ms}^{-1}$$

$$v_2 = \left(\frac{2m_1}{m_1 + m_2}\right) u_1 + \left(\frac{m_2 - m_1}{m_1 + m_2}\right) u_2$$

$$v_2 = \left(\frac{2m}{m + 2m}\right) 10 + \left(\frac{2m - m}{m + 2m}\right) 5$$

$$v_2 = \left(\frac{2}{3}\right) 10 + \left(\frac{1}{3}\right) 5 = \frac{20 + 5}{3} = \frac{25}{3}$$

$$v_2 = 8.33 \text{ ms}^{-1}$$

As the two speeds v_1 and v_2 are positive, they move in the same direction with the velocities, 3.33 m s^{-1} and 8.33 m s^{-1} respectively.

4.4.3 Perfect inelastic collision

In a perfectly inelastic or completely inelastic collision, the objects stick together permanently after collision such that they move with common velocity. Let the two bodies with masses m_1 and m_2 move with initial velocities u_1 and u_2 respectively before collision. After perfect inelastic collision both the objects move together with a common velocity v as shown in Figure (4.17).

Since, the linear momentum is conserved during collisions,

$$m_1 u_1 + m_2 u_2 = (m_1 + m_2)\, v$$

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